

Copying

The amoeba's nucleus contains DNA—a substance that carries genetic instructions for keeping the amoeba alive. Amoebas reproduce by splitting in two. DNA in the nucleus copies itself.

Splitting up

As the amoeba's cell splits down the middle, the single nucleus divides into two nuclei. They are exact copies of the nucleus of the original parent.

"Fingers" disappear during division.

See also

Find out about the dandelion (60–61), which produces identical offspring, like the amoeba.

Twins

Each new amoeba now contains copies of the DNA, making them identical twins—and they are identical to their parent too! They are now ready to grow and hunt for prey.